

R. Ray Barnes

The Art of Poetry

Volume 2

Butterfly Thoughts



The Art Of Poetry: Butterfly Thoughts

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Volume 2

Butterfly Thoughts

By R. Ray Barnes



R. Ray Barnes Productions

R. Ray Barnes

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**THE ART OF POETRY
VOLUME 2
BUTTERFLY THOUGHTS**

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The Power Of Uniting In Love

When you inner-connect spiritually with that special someone, that special “true love,” your “soul mate,” the energy created from this spiritual union of love gives birth to a oneness that transforms you and your mate into a single more dynamic source for love and manifestation of love, much greater than either of you could be alone, whose capacity for and capability to love increases exponentially. When this occurs, by virtue of the power and impact inherent in such a fusion of love, it will become the most important occurrence in your life—and could very well be the closest thing you’ll ever experience that mirror and reflects the “first love” that the creator had for humankind.



R. Ray Barnes

Acknowledgments

*I wish to thank all the persons, places, and things that have
touched my life and given me inspiration...*

*To everyone that I have been fortunate enough to meet,
befriend, care for and love; especially those who have been kind and
loving enough to care for me.*

To my dear wife Diane and my family:

*Damon, Christopher, Jordan, Damon Ray, LaDraya, EJ,
Brianna and Isaiah for loving despite my imperfections.*

*Especially to my parents Robert and Yvonne Barnes,
these thoughts are merely an extension of the love and wisdom that
you've given me.*

Your love and spirit are always a part of what I do.

I love and thank you with all my heart.

May you rest eternally in peace forever together...

*And a special thanks
to my son Damon for selecting some of the poems.*



Dedication

To all those who seek true love...

You must always remember and never forget---that you are more than what meets the eye. The essence of your beauty lies within. So don't be afraid to look deep inside to explore the full expanse of your heart and inner soul.

If you dare to undertake the journey, you will find there a boundless treasure of love and great gifts of understanding, patience and trust just waiting for you to discover and claim...

You may have visited your inner essence before at midnight in your dreams and didn't remember its existence.

However, to realize your treasures and receive your wonderful gifts, you must venture there at midday with your subconscious mind wide open to the fullness of the creator's bright light so that you may clearly envision the vast riches that were bequeathed to you.

Once accomplished, if you then share the treasures of that knowledge and understanding wisely, your heart shall be filled with enough love, peace, joy, and happiness to last forever...

Contents

The Power Of Uniting In Love	iv
Acknowledgments	v
Dedication	vi
A Part Of You	2
A Ray Of Sunshine.....	3
A Sweet Breath Away	5
Be Careful.....	7
Bell Bottoms & Platform Shoes.....	9
Blowin' In The Wind.....	10
Butterfly Thoughts	11
Cried.....	13
Cyber Dating.....	14
Dating Game.....	16
Extra Sensory Perception	17
Feelings	18
Forever	20
Free Falling... ..	25
Growth	27
Her Smile.....	28
I Can See No Way Out.....	30
I Do Know That... ..	31
I Need To Enjoy Life More Often... ..	33
I Never Knew... ..	34
I Thought You Said You Were A Lawyer?	35

I Will No Longer Be Able To Meet	38
I Wonder.....	41
If Love Was.....	42
If Our Love Must End.....	44
Illusions / Reality	46
Image Of An Angel	47
Inventory	49
Just A Thought Of You	51
Lady Love	52
Looks Can Be Deceiving.....	53
Love & Understanding	55
Love Is A Butterfly.....	56
Love Is Never Having To Say... ..	58
Love...Easier Said Than Done.....	60
Make Yourself At Home.....	62
Maybe In Time	63
Miss You	64
My Dream	65
My Friend.....	67
My Garden Of Love	68
My Heart Strings	70
My Tears	71
One Day... ..	72
One Of A Kind	74
Open Your Heart.....	76
Pleasant Thoughts	77
Rejected	79

Ridin' High	80
Spirit Love	81
Stay Tuned	82
The Light	83
The Only You You've Got	84
Thinking About You	85
Thoughts Of You	87
Tightrope	88
To What Do I Owe This Love Affair?	89
Trapped	90
Two Ten AM LA Time	91
Un-Love	93
Unconditional Love.....	95
Unraveled	96
When I Look Into Your Beautiful Green Eyes	97
When We're Together	99
When Your Love Is Far Away	101
Wherever Your Love Takes Me	103
Who Knew?	106
Without Your Smile	108
You Went Away	110

R. Ray Barnes

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A Part Of You

whenever i want to experience

True Beauty...

i need only to

Look Into Your Eyes

See Your Smile

Taste Your Kiss

Hear Your Voice

Feel Your Touch...

because,

everything that is

A Part Of You

is

Beautiful...

&

everything that is

Beautiful

is

A Part Of You

A Ray Of Sunshine

I know you've been

Swimming

in a

Stormy Sea

of doubt & mistrust---

with male

Sharks

all around you.

But,

if you can swim just a little bit

longer and further,

the

Storm Clouds

will pass---

and

you will find yourself in a

Sea of Tranquility

basking in

A Ray of Sunshine

as the

Tide

gently washes you upon

My

Tropical Island

of

Love...



A Sweet Breath Away

*I was just sittin' here reminiscin' about yo' kissin'
and all the sensuous passion I've been missin,'
and damn, I can no longer
wait, wait, wait, and anticipate
the pleasure, joy, and laughter that we let escape...*

*We must find a way to rediscover that first day
when you arrived here in L.A
and how we did play & play & lay & say
how nice it was to be embraced this way...*

*I miss the rhythmic rhyme of making love
all the time over and over again,
knowing not the beginning from its end,
we were such wonderful lovers and friends.
Never a fuss or fight, never a cuss or gripe,
your love light was always in flight---so tight, so right!
and oh, what a beautiful sight.*

*We sailed the ocean blue, made waves in hot tubs too,
river rafted until we were soaking wet,
flew over snow-capped mountains in a rickety jet,
stood atop of Toronto's CN Tower*

*and stared at Niagara's rainbows for hours---
It was just you and me from the desert to the sea,
You and I never asking why just touching the sky...*

*So, tell me, when will we see those days again,
letting our hearts give in to what we've been truly feelin'?
We mustn't try to hide what we really feel inside---*

*So, let's just abide and glide
into another wonderful love ride.
If only for a night and a day, let's just have it "our way..."
So, hey what do you say? A night of passion and love is just
A Sweet Breath Away...
A Sweet Breath Away...
A Sweet Yes Away...*

Be Careful

Be Careful

*of what you **wish**;
for there is one who can
make wishful thinking
a reality.*

Be Careful

*of what you think;
for your thoughts
can be made manifest.*

Be Careful

*of what you **ask**;
for your questions
can be answered
with truths.*

Be Careful

*of what you **say**;
for your words
can be heard
and acted upon.*

Be Careful

*of what you **do**;
for there is one who
knows your actions
and can bring them
to act upon **You**.*

Be Careful

Be Very Careful,
*for these things
i have come to know...
because they are now
happening
to **Me**.*



Bell Bottoms & Platform Shoes

don't make the mistake of giving up your

Designer Suit

for a trendy pair of

Bell Bottoms & Platform Shoes

that will soon be out of style...

besides,

how long do you expect to wear

Platform Shoes

when you already know you have flat feet?



Blowin' In The Wind

May

Our Hearts



fly high with the

Wind---

and blow far into the

Night---

awaking at

Dawn to a Horizon of

Love, Peace, Joy & Happiness

Butterfly Thoughts

*It was
after midnight
and the fog was dense
as the steam spewed out of the pores
of the weary dancers---
then suddenly,
like lightning flashing across a dark sky,
out of the mist **you** appeared...*

*And though
i didn't chance to touch you,
**your smile revealed
how soft you were---**
and though
the music was blaring,
**i heard your eyes as they
whispered sweet melodies into my eyes---**
and like a
Beautiful Flower,
you spoke with
**your presence, your tenderness,
your fragrance, your magnificence---**
and*

i stood by mesmerized, just
listening, looking,
and
watching your beauty unfold...
hoping---
that by morning's dawn
i would have become a
Butterfly



Cried

YOU cried

in my arms last night...

and though i knew not why,

i did

hear your tears,

i did

taste your pain,

i did

feel your sorrow,

and

i did

see your need for

love & understanding...

but little

did

you know,

I cried too.

Cyber Dating

Cyber eyeing,
Cyber trying,
Cyber lying,
Cyber spying,
Cyber denying,
Cyber crying---

Cyber chatting,
Cyber catting,
Cyber spating---

Cyber trust,
Cyber lust,
Cyber disgust,
Cyber bust---

And waiting, and waiting, and waiting,
Anticipating.....until it becomes
Cyber hating---

That's
Cyber Dating...

Then you came along,
Cyber relating---

R. Ray Barnes

until it became

Cyber mating---

That too is

Cyber Dating

Dating Game

You're An Angel...

and you must

Spread your Wings

and

stop trying to understand

why all the men you

Date

merely walk...

And,

while visiting on this

Earthly Plain---

You

need to spend

all your precious moments

trying to understand how to

Fly Higher...

for it is there,

In the Heavens,

Among the Stars,

that you shall find

Your Souls' Mate

Extra Sensory Perception

*How is it that I can **Feel---***

The rhythm of your heartbeat

From so very far across the world?

*How is it that I can **See---***

The sparkle in your emerald eyes

Shining so bright even in complete darkness?

*How is it that I can **Hear---***

The melody of your thoughts

Even though we are miles and miles apart?

*How is it that I can **Taste---***

The sweetness of your love

Even when my mouth is wide shut?

*How is it that I can **Smell---***

The fragrance of your spirit

Even as we stand amid a rose garden?

*Maybe it's because I **Sense---***

Me** falling in love with **You...

Feelings

i sometimes have

Feelings

*before i understand why
or exactly what i am*

Feeling.

*then, i have a yearning
to rush diagnosis.
so, i conjure up
every possible reason
for having such a*

Feeling

*and often my diagnosis
is incorrect,
causing me worry,
fear, tension, pain,
paranoia, anxiety,
discomfort, agony,
grief and distress...
usually,
resulting in a worse*

Feeling.

sometimes

Feelings

are better left

alone.



Forever

*I have asked the **Creator**...*

***To** awaken me each morning---*

to your beautiful brown eyes and bright smile...

***In** the same way that **She** awakens the night
to the beautiful blue skies and brightness of dawn.*

*I have asked **Christ**...*

***To** make my skin tingle daily---*

from the warmth and gentleness of your caress...

***In** the same way that **He** makes the leaves
quiver each day,
from the warm and gentle breezes of
mother nature's exhale.*

*I have asked the **Great Spirit**...*

***To** cause me to pause each day---*

to taste the sugary flavor of your tender kiss...

***In** the same way that **He** causes the honeybee
to savor the nectar and the morning dew
to kiss softly the daffodils.*

*I have asked **Horus**...*

***To** act in my behalf---*

*that my heart may be weighed on a scale of love,
opposite yours---creating perfect balance...*

***In** the same way that **He** sets nature's scales,
so that the seasons weigh perfectly opposite
each other, and the day stands in equal
balance with the night.*

*I have asked **Allah**...*

***To** allow my soul to sing its melody---*

*blending in sweet harmony with yours,
giving birth to our love song...*

***In** the same way that **He** allows the birds
to sing together,
harmonizing with all the sounds of nature,
while simultaneously vocalizing their calls for love.*

*I have asked **Amen Ra**...*

***To** make my love melt each evening---*

*slowly like butter---disappearing inside of you,
as it becomes absorbed by your love...*

***In** the same way that **He** makes the sun melt slowly,
oozing its way into the ocean every day at sunset.*

*I have asked **Isis**...*

***To** bestow her blessings upon me---*

*that I may plant my healthy seed of life deep inside
your womb,*

so that you shall become a great mother of mothers...

***In** the same way that **She** has blessed the sun
to shine its **Rays** of nurturing life deep inside
the earth's womb causing it to be the greatest
mother of all.*

*I have asked **Osiris**...*

***To** make you appear to me---*

even when my eyes are closed,

***To** allow me to hear, feel, smell, and touch you,
even when you're not present, and*

***To** give unto me the courage
and faith to love you unconditionally...*

***In** the same way that **He** allows me
to see, hear, feel, smell, and touch him,
even when he doesn't appear to be present, and*

***In** the same way that **He** grants me the faith
and courage to love **Him** unconditionally.*

*Now that I have asked the **Gods**,*

*I shall ask **You**...*

To Stand By Me

*the way that **Isis** stood by **Osiris**...*

To Stand By Me

*the way the **Sphinx** stands by the **Pyramids**...*

To Stand By Me

*the way **1** stands by **2** and **3** stands by **4**...*

To Stand By Me

*the way the **Moon** stands by the **Sun**...*

To Stand By Me

*the way the **Sky** stands by the **Stars**...*

To Stand By Me

*the way **North** stands by **South***

*and **East** stands by **West**...*

To Stand By Me

*the way **Time** stands by **Eternity**...*

To Stand By Me

*the way **My Shadow** stands by **Me**...*

To Stand By Me

*the way **Christ** stands by **Love**...*

*So, **My Dear**,*

*I am asking **You***

To Take My Hand---

and,

To Stand By Me

Forever...



Free Falling...

You've got Me
high, so high
in the stratosphere of my emotions,
that now i feel myself
Falling, Falling...
Free Falling
in Love with you.

i've kicked caution to the wind,
as my journey towards love begins,
drifting through soft clouds of joy,
with no abort switch to deploy,
as i feel myself
Falling, Falling...
Free Falling
in Love with you.

i have no parachute in my gear,
no safety net to ease my fear,
no ocean waters to break my fall,
and no emergency personnel to call,
i'm just
Falling, Falling...

Free Falling
in Love with you.

*i'm falling so fancy free,
with my faith in our love to be,
aided by a gentle breeze of ecstasy,
with only your heart i entrust to catch me,
as i am indeed*

Falling, Falling...

Free Falling
in Love with you



Growth

*i have **grown**...*

*i have **grown***

in love, in spirit, in mind

and

in understanding...

yet,

my friends perceive **me** to be quite the same,

causing me to wonder...

*have i **grown***

as much as “i” think i have?

or

*have i **grown***

as much as my friends think i have?

or

*have i **grown***

as much as my friends are capable

of thinking i have?

...maybe it's just time

for me

to change the company

i keep...

Her Smile

*HER SMILE IS LIKE ... **Her Smile**
not like **Mona Lisa's**...
though **Her** Smile
is just as captivating.*

*HER SMILE IS LIKE ... **Her Smile**
not like **Street Ladies**...
who smile because
they want to sell you something,
though she could sell you any-thing
with **Her** Smile.*

*HER SMILE IS LIKE ... **Her Smile**
not like **Politicians**...
who smile because
it's all a part of their act,
no! Her act is all a part
of **Her** Smile - natural.*

*HER SMILE IS LIKE ... **Her Smile**
not like **Commercial Actresses**...
who smile because
they are paid to smile,
though many have paid tribute*

to **Her Smile**

*HER SMILE IS LIKE ... **Her Smile**
not like **TV ads** and **Billboards...**
promoting Colgate and Ultra Bright,
though **Her Smile** is ultra-bright.*

*HER SMILE IS LIKE ... **Her Smile**
and when they see **HER SMILE**
people listen---
because, when she smiles*

Her Heart

has spoken...



I Can See No Way Out

*your love is so **HIGH***

i can't get over it...

*your feelings are so **DEEP***

i can't get under them...

*your heart is so **WIDE***

i can't get around it...

and now

i can see no way out

of giving you

all My Love.



I Do Know That...

i may not know much---but,

I Do Know That...

you are blessed

*with a **wonderful** spirit*

that touches the hearts

of those who seem to be

untouchable...

...and i know too, that

"I" think you are wonderful.

i may not know much---but,

I Do Know That...

the creator has showered you

*with **beauty** and tenderness*

that permits you to walk

among flowers with no

shame...

...and i know too, that

"I" think you are beautiful.

i may not know much---but,

I Do Know That...

*your generous **concern** for others
has been reciprocated
by the Creator's
watchful eye and guidance
over your **concerns**...*

...and i know too, that

"I" care about what you care about.

i may not know much---but,

I Do Know That...

"I"

Love

You



I Need To Enjoy Life More Often...

I need to---

Smile more often

Giggle more often

Laugh more often

Crack myself up

and just

Laugh uncontrollably ***More Often....***

I need to---

Hug more often

Kiss more often

Share more often

Care more often

and make

Mad passionate ***Love More Often....***

I just need to---

Enjoy Life More Often....

*Because I've noticed---When ***Life*** is over,*

Death endures a whole lot longer,

and

Dead People don't seem to have
much ***Fun.***

I Never Knew...

i never knew

Love could Give

and make me

want to Give

so freely.

i only wish

i could Live

forever

with your Love

beside me.

i never knew

Love could Bring

all the joy you Bring

to me.

i never knew

Love could Sing

such a pretty

melody.

...and

i thank You

for introducing Me to Love.

I Thought You Said You Were A Lawyer?

According to my best recollection,

I Thought You Said You Were A Lawyer?

Which is generally taken to mean, that one is an expert in

***Legal** matters,*

*and maybe even practices **Law**.*

*However, it seems to me, you're more likely a **Magician---***

*the way you always manage to expose **My Hidden Card**,*

that I thought I had cleverly concealed

***Deep** within **My Soul**.*

*For someone masquerading as a **Barrister**,*

*it's mighty **Strange** how you seem to **Magically** make*

My "Cool" Disappear...

And besides,

*I thought **Lawyers** were supposed to be notorious*

for lying all the time---

*Then, "**Miss Legal Eagle**,"*

how is it that you always speak so

***Truthfully & Sincerely** from the **Heart**?*

Have you been

Disbarred?

And another thing...

***I Thought You Said** you were so busy?*

*Well, if that be true, how is it that
you have the time to leave me such
sweet, adorable messages,
breaking down my defenses and making me blush...
especially when I'm trying my best to maintain this*

Cool Attitude

*that I can't be touched deep inside---
I hope you know you're really **F'ing** with **My Image**...*

And yeah, I mustn't forget,

I Thought You Said *you came to Los Angeles*

only to seek employment opportunities?

*Notwithstanding the foregoing, I guess you just so happen to
unwittingly flash those*

Big Beautiful Brown Eyes that Mesmerized Me---

causing me to spend more time thinking about

You than I do My God...

*And after having heard your **Testimony**, seen your*

Body Language,

Listen Closely *to credible **Witnesses** to your **Actions**;*

you really expect me to believe that your visit to

The City of Angels

was merely happenstance and not by divine design?

And you wonder why

Attorneys *have such awful reputations.*

*And what about the fact that you said
that you were from **New York**,
Am I supposed to believe that too?
Well, I know you **Counselors** think you know everything,
but I'm sorry to disappoint you---
Just because you may like the **Knicks**, the **Yankees**,
the **Mets**, **Manhattan**, **Brooklyn**, **Uptown** the **Bronx**,
Harlem, **Queens**, **Staten Island**, **Coney Island**,
Central Park, **Times Square**, **Sylvia's**, the **Apollo**, **Nathan's**, **Taxi's**,
Subways, **Broadway Shows**, **Bridges**, **Tunnels**, **Skyscrapers**, **Soho**,
the **Village**, **Museums**
and maybe even **Mt. Vernon**...
However, I must object!
My Darling, **My Sweets**, **My Dear**---
No matter how much you would like to
claim **New York** as your home,
your evidence is merely circumstantial.
The whole truth, and nothing but the truth is...
Angels only come from **Heaven**...*

I Will No Longer Be Able To Meet With You Alone

My Dearest Sweetheart:

As much as I regret having to do so,

I must inform you that---

I Will No Longer Be Able To

Meet With You Alone...

From Now On...

*I need to meet with you at **Dawn***

*when the **Sun** is **Slowly Rising**---*

In order that I may counteract

the captivating brilliance of your smile

that compels me to move closer to the light that's

shining deep within your heart.

From Now On...

*I need to meet with you in the **Midst** of a*

***Botanical Garden*---**

When the air around is filled

with a flowery bouquet

so that I may have something to

counteract the sweet fragrance that emanates from every

aspect of your being.

From Now On...

*I need to meet with you at **Beauty Pageants***

where I will be surrounded by

Hundreds of Gorgeous Women---

*To counteract my uncontrollable urge to stare
transfixed at your shapely profile.*

From Now On...

*I need to meet with you on the **Beach At Sunset***

*when the **Sun Gently Kisses the Horizon---***

*To counteract my overwhelming need
to gently set my lips upon your
soft and luscious lips.*

From Now On...

*I need to meet with you at **Midnight***

*when I will have the **Scintillating Glistening of the Stars---***

*To counteract the alluring gleam
in your beautiful eyes,
that keeps me hypnotized
and unable to focus upon anything but you.*

From Now On...

*I need to meet with you at a **Convention of Angels***

*where there will be a number of **Kindred Spirits---***

*To counteract my desire
to become totally consumed
by the compassionate nature of your*

tender soul.

So,

My Dear,

I hope you understand,

that until further notice,

I Will No Longer Be Able To

Meet With You Alone...



I Wonder

i wonder what your heart
would bring **in a marketplace of love?**
i wonder whose window seal
you'd sit **if you were a spring dove?**



i wonder what your thoughts
would be **if they were simply drifting free?**
i wonder what your eyes
would see **if they could only look at me?**
i wonder what your hands
would feel **if i were their only touch?**
&
i wonder if i would even
wonder **if i didn't love you so much?**

If Love Was...

IF Love Was

A Flower

*it would be a **Rose***

IF Love Was

A Tree

*it would be a **Redwood***

IF Love Was

A Bird

*it would be a **Flamingo***

IF Love Was

An Insect

*it would be a **Butterfly***

IF Love Was

An Animal

*it would be a **Lioness***

IF Love Was

A River

*it would be the **Nile***

IF Love Was

A Mountain

*it would be **Everest***

IF Love Was

A Valley

*it would be the **Grand Canyon***

IF Love Was

A Building

*it would be the **Great Pyramid***

IF Love Was

A Gift

*it would be the **Taj Mahal***

IF Love Was

A Planet

*it would be **Earth***

IF Love Was

A Season

*it would be **Spring***

IF Love Was

A Light

*it would be the **Sun***

IF Love Was

A Feeling

*it would be **Joy***

&

IF Love Was A Woman she would be You

If Our Love Must End...

If Our Love Must End,

*let it end in **Peace**...for we shall not go to **War***

because

Our Hearts

cease to beat two-gether, and

Our Eyes

cease to focus upon the same star, and

Our Ears

cease to hear the same melody

that we so long simultaneously enjoyed.

***Love** is not promised to endure a lifetime, and*

***Love** doesn't have an average life expectancy of 65.*

***Love's Time** is measured by **Love Itself**--*

to which, too long may be a day, and

too short may be a lifetime.

but i thank whosoever made it possible

*for **Us** to **Share In Love** the time we did...*

and though storm clouds may loom today

i hope you find sunshine after the pouring rain...

remember, it's the rain that brings the flowers in spring, and

it's the bitter wind that blows the seeds aground and

permits new trees to grow and bare sweet fruit again...

*and if you ever need a heart to lean on...
you know my heart will always be open to you, and
when you are lonely and just need to share your mind,
i'll always find time to listen.*

*you know, time brings about change, and
i think it was time for us to move on to other things.
but, they say **What Goes Around, Will Come Around**
and i am sure **Our Love Will Come Again.***

*so, let us spread our wings and be free, and
let us not be enemies...*

for you'll never know when you'll

Need A Friend Again & Again & Again...



Illusions / Reality

It's easy

to visualize

YOU

in my thoughts...

It's easy

to picture

YOU

in my dreams...

It's easy

to imagine

YOU

in my fan-ta-sees...

But it's

not so easy

to visualize, to picture, to imagine

YOU not being here WITH ME...

*because that's **FOR REAL***

Image Of An Angel

*The **Museum** was wonderful...
as was all the **Art & Sculpture** within it.
The featured artist was **William Pajaud**
and his exhibit was entitled,
“**The Sights and Sounds of My New Orleans.**”
However, there was one very exceptional work of art,
that stood apart from all the others in the museum.
Its **Sight** was so **Beautiful** and the
Harmony of its **Spirit**
seemed to surround everything that came near it.*

*It was a
3 Dimensional Mixed Media Abstract Sculpture,
that somehow embodied all the **Elements** of **Fine Art**.
At my initial cursory view of it,
I did not recognize its **Theme**.
Nor did I notice the **Name** of the **Artist**.
Yet,
It's **Composition, Form & Shape**
were exquisite.
And it's **Lines, Colors & Texture**
were equally discriminating.
It was **Futuristic**, yet **Classic**.*

*It was **Idealistic**, yet **Natural**.*

*It was **Expressionistic**, yet **Real***

*It was **Formalistic**, yet very **Stylized**.*

*It seemed so **Surreal** the way it was affecting me,*

*I was eager to discover who had created such a magnificent work of
art.*

Yet, still, no recognized artist came to mind.

*Then, it began to **Speak**---*

After careful examination and admiration,

*I recognized the **Image** to be that of an **Angel**,*

and

The Artist Was God...

Yes!

*The **Museum** was wonderful...*

*as was all the **Art & Sculpture** within it.*

*However, that **Image** of an **Angel***

*that was **Fashioned By God**, was entitled*

“YOU”

...and I would like to make you a part of

My Permanent Collection!

Inventory

My shop is closed---
closed temporarily,
for i am taking inventory,
inventory on my life.

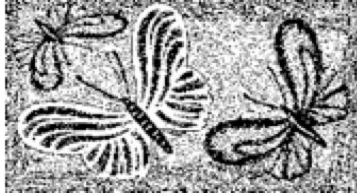
I must re-stock---
re-stock my shelves,
for i have run short on
patience,
determination,
perseverance,
and sometimes
just the will to want to
carry on...

but,
I must replenish---
replenish my-self,
for there are some goods
I seem never to keep enough of...

So,
i must acquire
more love

&

More Love
&
MORE LOVE
&
FAITH...
that my shop will
never close for
Lack of Goods.



Just A Thought Of You

A thought of you is

Tap Dancing---ever so lightly
in the corner my mind...

I can feel you

Tip-Toeing---through the hidden recesses
of my heart playing hide and seek...

I can taste your spirit as it

Glides Along---so slippery wet upon my lips...
I can see you frolicking in my minds' eye

Showing Me---moving pictures
of heartwarming stories of love...

I can hear the smooth rhythmic melody of your soul

Beating Softly---as it gently caresses
my ear-drum...

I can smell the sensuously sweet honeysuckle

Aroma Therapy---that emanates
from your love...

Just A Thought Of You

always seems to make me feel
soooo good...

Please come again---soon!

Lady Love

a

Lady

came into my life today

&

touched me with her eyes,

held me with her heart,

embraced me with her spirit,

&

Loved me all over...

&

as quickly as she came...

she went away...

so

i blew her a kiss

&

said,

i hope you come again...

soon.

Looks Can Be Deceiving

*most times,
the new
Love's
we discover
meet **Our Eyes** before they meet **Our Hearts**...*
*&
before we venture to take our newfound
Love
on that arduous trip to visit **Our Hearts**,
we usually come upon
a fork in the road...*
*&
often
the journey to **Our Hearts**
becomes the road not taken...
as **Our Eyes** leads us to travel the road
that looks paved and smooth---
tree lined and picturesque---
which is most pleasing to **Our Eyes**...
even though the road sign above clearly reads,
"Dead End Ahead.
you see,
Our Eyes*

*are very selfish,
and would much rather travel a smooth looking road
that leads to **Nowhere**---
than traverse the unsightly cobblestone path
with the steep hill
that leads to **Paradise**...*

*we must learn,
the search for true
Love
is much too important a task to be relegated to
Our Eyes alone---
the **Mind, Body, Soul, and Spirit** must participate...
because,
Looks Can Be Deceiving*

Love & Understanding

WHERE THERE IS ONLY A LITTLE understanding,

THERE CAN ONLY BE A LITTLE love.

IS

ONLY

A

LITTLE

*under-
standing,*



THERE

CAN

ONLY

BE

A

LITTLE

love.

Love Is A Butterfly

*Just trust in **Love** and don't ask why---*

And stop trying to separate the sun

From the other stars in the sky.

*Your heart bleeds **Love***

And you can't deny,

Cause I'm blinded by the gleam

That's always in your eye...

***Love** is not about you,*

Nor is it about me,

***Love** is just fulfilling*

Its own need to be---

*So don't cage **Love** in, just let it fly free,*

And it'll carry your spirit on a journey to ecstasy...

So don't try to read in-between the lines,

And don't over analyze it in your mind,

Don't call psychics on the phone,

And don't invite clairvoyants into your home,

Don't try to get your doctor to explain it,

Don't try to rename it or disclaim it...

*Just trust in **Love***

And don't ask why---and don't try to count

R. Ray Barnes

*All the stars that go by,
Just set **Love** free to soar high,
Cause just like you,
Love Is A Butterfly*



Love Is Never Having To Say...

*you wash my troubles away,
you bathe my thoughts,
and you massage my heart
with passionate emotions of love.*

So You Don't Have To Say

You Love Me

Because I Already Know.

*you're always there when i need you,
if not in person, in spirit
i can feel your love and affection.*

So You Don't Have To Say

You Love Me

Because I Already Know.

*in dark rooms on pillows of love,
when our bodies become a physical eclipse
and our hearts become our vision---*

we always see eye to eye.

So You Don't Have To Say

You Love Me

Because I Already Know.

*when sorrow beckons me,
you mystically appear*

R. Ray Barnes

*with expressions of joyfulness
and
my sorrow vanishes---like a desert mirage*

***So You Don't Have To Say
You Love Me
Because I Already Know.***

***True Love Is
Never Having To Say...
"I Love You"***

*...but then again---
i sure love it when you do!*

Love...Easier Said Than Done

when our passions intersect at levels

above and beyond

my degree of comprehension---

it seems to make me want to say

"I Love You..."

but i cannot truly say

"I Love You"

because love exists

on a level

in which i lack comprehension---

but i can say

i want you to be here with me.

*maybe **Love** defines itself*

and never intended

for people to make mockery

of its wide range of definitions.

*maybe **Love** was*

never meant to be said

and

never meant to heard

but

*only meant to be felt...
and
when one experiences true **Love**
it brings about passions indescribable---
until the feelings
of
Love
are gone...
leaving no room for
deceiving tricks to be played,
based on the mere auditory reception
of the pleasing sounds of the words
"I Love You..."
...yes!
Love
has always been a lot
Easier Said Than Done*

Make Yourself At Home

Just
when i thought i had
CLOSED AND LOCKED SHUT
the
Door To My Heart...
you
OPENED
the
Window To My Love
and
CLIMBED IN...

...and
Now That You Have Come Inside,
why don't you just sit down
and
Make Yourself At Home...

Maybe In Time

Maybe In Time

we may call it sublime, but, as of yet

I can't imagine a name.

A name for the time

that your heart has been mine,

*and the **Love** that we have shared the same.*

*It's the same kind of **Love***

that's in heaven above,

that no one has been able to explain.

*And to explain a **Love***

that fit's like a glove,

is an impossible

claim to in-frame...

but,

Maybe In Time

we may call it sublime,

but, as of yet

I can't imagine a name.



Miss You

*i never thought you'd
leave,
vanish,
go away,
disappear,
take off...
but even more to my surprise,*



*i never thought i'd
miss you,
want you,
crave,
desire,
and yearn
to be with you again.*

My Dream

*when i met **You**, i felt as if
i had come face 2 face with the
Star of My Dream...
yes! that **Dream...**the one when i meet
My Match, My Soul Mate, My Mirror Image.
then, we fall in **Love---**& we make love
we get **Married---**& we make love
we have **Kids---**& we make love
we become extremely **Wealthy---**& we make love
maybe even **Famous---**& we make more love
we buy a **House** with a **Tennis Court---**& we make love
we buy **Homes** for **Our Parents---**& we make love
we travel **The World---**& we make love
we help the **Needy---**& we make love
we bring **Our People Together---**& we make love
we **Laugh a Lot---**& we have fun while we make love
we **Cry Sometime---**& we make love
we experience **Joy & Peace** and
Live Happily Ever After---& we still make love.
however, after standing there looking into
Your Eyes, seeing **Your Smile**, feeling **Your Spirit**,
such a chance encounter seemed too divine to be real---
so, i carefully examined my surroundings*

seeking verification:

*it wasn't **Midnight**---it was mid-day,
i wasn't **Asleep**---i was wide awake,
i wasn't **Intoxicated**---i don't drink.
and though **Rain** was **Threatening** in L.A.
i wasn't depressed or hallucinating,
i was in complete control of my faculties,
yet, it felt so much like **My Dream**.*

*though, in **My Dream***

*i made numerous requests to see you in the **Flesh**,
but you would simply answer,*

"In Time My Love, I Will Come to You in Time..."

*...now, there you were standing before me
while i stood staring at you in **Disbelief**...
not because i lacked faith that you would come;
about that i had **No Doubts!***

*I **Prayed** too **Hard** and too **Long** for you,
i knew you would come!*

*i just didn't expect in **Reality**,*

***You** would appear*

***More Beautiful** than i pictured **You** in **My Dream**.*

My Friend

when

A Friend

enters your life,

A Friend

never leaves...

A Friend

remains

*in your **Heart**,*

*in your **Mind**,*

and

*in your **Soul**...*

because

A Friend

is always and forever

A Friend

&

I Thank You

*for being **My Friend***

My Garden Of Love

Come Into My Garden

and let

Me plant You

in

Love.

i can see you need re-planting and

i would love to have you in my

Oasis.

Come Into My Garden

and let me

fertilize you with understanding.

i can tell you've been with one who doesn't understand

nor appreciates,

that nature's most precious flowers are the most fragile

and need the most care.

Come Into My Garden

and let me

water you with tenderness.

for it is obvious that your leaves have been damaged,

R. Ray Barnes

*your stem bruised and your petals have been
falling... falling... falling...
aground.*

Come Into My Garden
and let me
shine my light
deep within your stem,
energizing & synthesizing
your spirit---making it come alive again,
for i know, you have been
besieged with cloudy days.
so please come,
at my invitation, at my request,
and let
Me plant You
in
My Garden Of Love



My Heart Strings

you've stretched

My Heart

.....
.....
.....
.....

so far...

if you keep on pulling

My Heart Strings...

soon,

My Heart

will

BRE-----AK!!!



My Tears

Henceforth and forevermore---

***My Tears** will only be*

droplets of dew

that kisses the flowers at dawn

and awakens them to

a brand new day...



One Day...

i am not

Wise

enough---

to put in words

how i really feel about you.

i am not

Gentle

enough---

to touch you

so softly that your body

tingles

&

tingles

&

tingles...

i am not

Strong

enough---

to hold you

R. Ray Barnes

*mentally, physically & spiritually
as i would like to.*

but you can

See

in my eyes---

that i want to,

wish to,

&

One Day

Will!

One Of A Kind

Every
Beautiful
Astonishing
Sexy
Fine
Witty
Charming
Foxy
Affectionate
Adoring
Soft
Sensitive
Caring
Wonderful
Amazing
Enchanting
Gorgeous
Heart Warming
Sweet
Thoughtful
Considerate

R. Ray Barnes

Lovely

Divine

woman that I see---

reminds

Me of You...

and though some similarities do exist,

none even come close to approaching your uniqueness---

because,

My Darling

you are truly

One Of A Kind

Open Your Heart...

If you would only dare to

Open Wide

the windows to

Your Heart...

you would

Feel

the

Warm Breezes

of

My Love



Pleasant Thoughts

i am lying here thinking

Pleasant Thoughts

of you.

and when i think of you

I smile.

you appear so lovely through my eyes,

it makes me recall the words of a wise man,

who said,

"There is beauty in everything

but cannot be seen by everyone."

but i indeed pity the fool

who cannot see the beauty in you...

because if

charm were the question,

no question you'd be the answer...

for if

your eyes were the sun,

there would never be a cloudy day...

and if

Love needed a path to follow,

your heart could surely lead the way...

like the many times you have led me

to think...

Pleasant Thoughts,

Pleasant Thoughts,

such

Pleasant Thoughts

of

You.

Rejected

You mustn't allow yourself to feel

Rejected---

because a

Blind Man

fails to recognize your beauty

and the

Deaf Man

is unable

to hear

the

Sweet Melody

of

Your Love



Ridin' High

i was worried...

i thought i'd never make it---

*my **Feet** were tired and swollen*

*my **Motor** had no fuel*

*my **Balloon** had been deflated*

*my **Sail** was without wind*

*my **Spirit** had no inspiration*

and

*my **Heart** was discontent*

then...

you came along

and

Took Me On A Love Ride...

and

i've been

Ridin' High

ever since...

Spirit Love

My Spirit

is

Falling In Love

with

Your Spirit...

and

I Pray

that

Our Hearts & Minds

will follow...



Stay Tuned

i've been

thinking about u,

crying out 4 u...

in night visions

in daydreams

&

in my fan-ta-sees.

i know my thoughts are blurred, but,

the picture is becoming clearer...

so please,

Stay Tuned

4 further developments

& keep your heart in focus,

*because there is **Moore 2** life than*

News,

Weather

&

Sports...

The Light

*there is a **Light** shining **Bright** at the end of the*

T

U

NN

E

L

to my heart...

&

i am

S

T

R

U

GG

L

I

N

G

to get to it---just hoping

The Light is YOU

The Only You You've Got

*You must
remember to remember---
that you are
The Only You You've Got.*

*So, you mustn't allow
anyone or anything
to hurt you...*

*Because **God** only made one **Angel**
who is sweet, kind, and beautiful as you!*



Thinking About You

on most nights i lie awake

misty eyed

and

can't get to sleep---

just

Thinking About You...

on other nights, i go to bed early

because i can't wait to get to sleep---

just so i can

Dream About You...

on this day, in the midst of a

solar eclipse,

i find myself again...

just

Day Dreaming About You...

as i heard

the oou's and ahh's of the spectators

as the last glow of the sun disappeared

and

a dark shadow was cast upon the earth,

i had yet to open my eyes---

once more,

just

Thinking About You...

*however, at that very moment
when the moon turned out the lights,
casting a cold veil of darkness over the world---*

my thoughts of you
turned on a light within my heart...

and

i could feel

my love smiling,

realizing---

*all that's needed to warm
my heart, brighten my life---*

is just

Thinking About You...

Thoughts Of You

This
morning at dawn,
I planted some wonderful seeds of thoughts...
just of you.
I then gazed at your photograph and paused---
Treating my senses to the joy and pleasure that one receives
when seeing your
emerald eyes and beautiful smile.
And from the tears that my
New Joy
brings, with loving tenderness,
I watered and fertilized my thoughts...
And by the time the moon began to work the nightshift,
My Thoughts Of You
had blossomed into a magnificent flower...
And like the hummingbird, I am poised in mid-flight
ready to drink of your
sweet nectar.

Tightrope

*I've
been walking across*

Our Love

on a

Tightrope



doing a

High Wire Balancing Act

Without A Net...

but now,

I think it's time for me to

Quit The Circus---

it seems no longer

Worth The Risk...

To What Do I Owe This Love Affair?

To What Do I Owe This Love Affair?

*that appeared out of a mist.
i only meant to be detained
by the fog,
certainly not lost in the gist.*

To What Do I Owe This Love Affair?

*for which i surely did not need
but for some unperceived reason,
it has sprouted like a weed.
for 'tis a weed that won't go up in smoke,
though at times i have drowned it
with pesticides,
never once has it choked. so...*

To What Do I Owe This Love Affair?

*when only games i wanted to play...
but maybe i owe it to you my dear*

for

Loving Me Anyway.

Trapped

you

Trapped Me

like a

Spider Traps

it's prey...

you did nothing...

i just walked

right into your

Silky Sexy Web

of

Love



Two Ten AM LA Time

i'm feeling you now---

lying down

standing upon

my thoughts of you---

Lovely Thoughts...

though you're probably asleep now

as dawn is swiftly drawing near,

you are still awake

in my heart,

in my mind,

&

in my love...

for

you are my love

&

my love you are

all the love that one could ask,

&

Lord knows i have asked,

&

i know you have given...

i'm feeling you now---

lying down,

standing upon our

Love

At



2:10 AM Los Angeles Time

Un-Love

*I
Am
In
A State
Of
Un-Love
At The
Moment*



*a place unfamiliar to me.
a state where i have no driver's license---
i feel lost at every turn.
i only go where it's necessary,
planning carefully my every move...
i was taken here,*

***Not By Choice,**
but captured by my higher self;*

kidnapped, arrested, mind-cuffed...

And

I

Thank

God

for i could have never come here

on my own,

even,

as bad as

i needed to.

Unconditional Love

you're much too special

to accept anything but

Unconditional Love

because,

Love

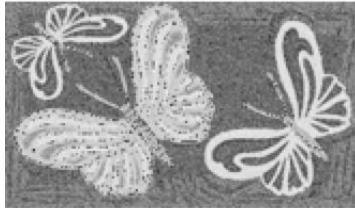
built on conditions

is like building

castles in the sand---

as soon as the first tide comes in

it all washes away...



Unraveled

*My
whole life
has become
-frayed and
-unraveled...*

*Like
the ends
of a
worn shoestring...
and i've been
-licking and
-twisting the ends...*



*But today i just can't seem
to make my life fit into
the w-hole
....however,
i will try again tomorrow!*

When I Look Into Your Beautiful Green Eyes

Sometimes---

When I Look Into Your Beautiful Green Eyes

*i see **Blue...***

*for all the **Sorrow***

that you have experienced---

*because you truly believed he **Loved** you...*

yet, his actions demonstrated that he didn't really care.

Sometimes---

When I Look Into Your Beautiful Green Eyes

*i see **Yellow...***

*for the **Fear***

that you have experienced---

being afraid to leave him, feeling you

*needed him to **Love** you...*

yet, his actions demonstrated that he didn't really care.

Sometimes---

When I Look Into Your Beautiful Green Eyes

*i see **Red...***

*for all the **Pain***

that you have suffered---

*because of all the **Sorrow & Fear***

that he has caused you...

yet, his actions demonstrated that he didn't really care.

Now---

When I Look Into Your Beautiful Green Eyes

*i see **Green**...*

*for all the **Green Pastures***

that lie ahead of you---

*realizing that you need only to **Love** yourself..*

and that action demonstrates

that you no longer

Need

him to

“really care”

When We're Together

When I'm With You

*the days melt together
like snow thawing
in a mountain stream---*

fluid & flowing

fluid & flowing

When We're Together

*time takes flight
on the "Blue Origin"
and the hours slip away
like fish thru wet hands---*

oops...

oops...

missed 'em

again

When We're Together

*our melodies blend
in perfect harmony,
majors no minors,
sharps no flats...*



like notes in the key of b---

B-natural

D-sharp

& F-sharp

Perfect Intervals...

just like

When We're Together

When Your Love Is Far Away

When Your Love Is Far Away

you can't bend over

and say,

"I Love You..."

not

When Your Love Is Far Away.

When Your Love Is Far Away

you can't whisper in her ear

and tell her the things

you've been longing to say,

that only comes to you the day

When Your Love Is Far Away.

When Your Love Is Far Away

you can't enjoy her smile,

that may last just a little while,

but doesn't last

in any way

When Your Love Is Far Away.

When Your Love Is Far Away

tears of loneliness are shown,

although you're really not alone,

because if she loves you too

and you believe it's true,

then you haven't a thing to say...



Because Her Love Is Also-----

----Far Away.

Wherever Your Love Takes Me

*I thought I wanted to go to
Disney World, Magic Mountain, and Cedar Point---
some magical, wild, and wonderful places,
where I could really enjoy myself and have lots of fun...*

*I thought maybe even a trip to
Hawaii, Jamaica, and Aruba---
some blissful island paradise,
where I could walk along the beach
and just play in the sand all day...*

*I thought to about a journey into
The Brazilian Rain Forest---
where I could truly sojourn with nature,
to observe some of the most marvelous wonders
that the Creator has afforded us...*

*I thought about an exploration to
The Arctic Circle---
where I could experience firsthand
the breathtaking and amazing
White Nights and Northern Lights...*

I gave serious thought about taking

An African Safari---

*Camping at the foothills of Kilimanjaro
and maybe even an adventurous trip across
the mighty sands of the Sahara...*

I thought about touring the

*Great ruins of **Greece** and **Rome**---*

*Riding a Gondola in **Venice**,
seeing **Paris** from the top of the Eiffel Tower,
and hanging out at The Louvre
with Vincent Van Gogh and Mona Lisa...*

I also thought about going to

Nepal---

*Just to take a helicopter ride
to get a great view from the top of the world at
Mount Everest---*

*Then descending to the ocean's bottom
to that mysterious place
where even sunlight has never been,*

*to behold bioluminescent fish with no eyes,
and jellyfish that know nothing of peanut butter...*

I thought about "painting the town" in

***Hollywood, San Francisco, New York, Tokyo,
Montreal, Las Vegas, and Dubai---***
and even taking an up close view of
***The Grand Canyon, Victoria Falls, The Taj Mahal and
The Great Pyramids of Egypt...***

*I thought about taking a trip to space on
Virgin Galactic, SpaceX, or Blue Origin,
so I could get a **God's Eye View** of our world
and float weightlessly where up knows no down
and down is surround...*

*But, more than wanting to do all those things,
I desire mostly to be wherever you are---*
*Traveling deep within your heart, and holding you
tightly around my spirit, on a journey of*
Love, Joy, Peace, Trust and Understanding,
and going happily
Wherever Your Love Takes Me...

Who Knew?

Who Knew That God---

*used the moisture from your tears
as the spring rain to re-awaken the flowers
and bring the green leaves back to trees...*

Who Knew That God---

*used your eyes as His inspiration
to make diamonds, emeralds
and pearls...*

Who Knew That God---

*used the sweetness of your kiss
to flavor honey, sugar
and molasses...*

Who Knew That God---

*used the brightness of your smile
to fashion the glow of the full moon
at midnight...*

Who Knew That God---

*used your touch
to define soft, sensitive,
and tender...*

Who Knew That God---

*used your devotion,
affection and passion
as **His** measure for love...*

Who Knew?

I Knew...

*and
i won't let anyone tell me
different---
and
now that you know, you must do
the same!*



Without Your Smile

How is it that i chance to meet you...?

A Beautiful Fair Maiden,

with a

Smile That Warms---

Like The Days Of Summer.

Yes!...what would the world be

Without Beautiful People?

what would the world be

Without Your Smile?

How elated was i to acquaint myself

with one whose beauty parallels

A Sunrise At Dawn

On The Most Pleasant Of Spring Days.

I have often asked myself, how is it...

that the

Light In Your Eyes

outshined all the

Stars In Heaven...

on a night when

The Sky

R. Ray Barnes

Scintillated Like Never Before?

*And if history could be re-lived
there may have never been a*

Mona Lisa...

because

Your Smile Is So Bright,

that at times it seems to

Embarrass The Sun.

Yes!...what would the world be

Without Beautiful People?

and how

Dim

the world would be

Without Your Smile...



You Went Away

You Went.....Away...

Now my

Spirit

is

Lifeless...



Survived only

by my hope

that we will

Come-Together-Again.

